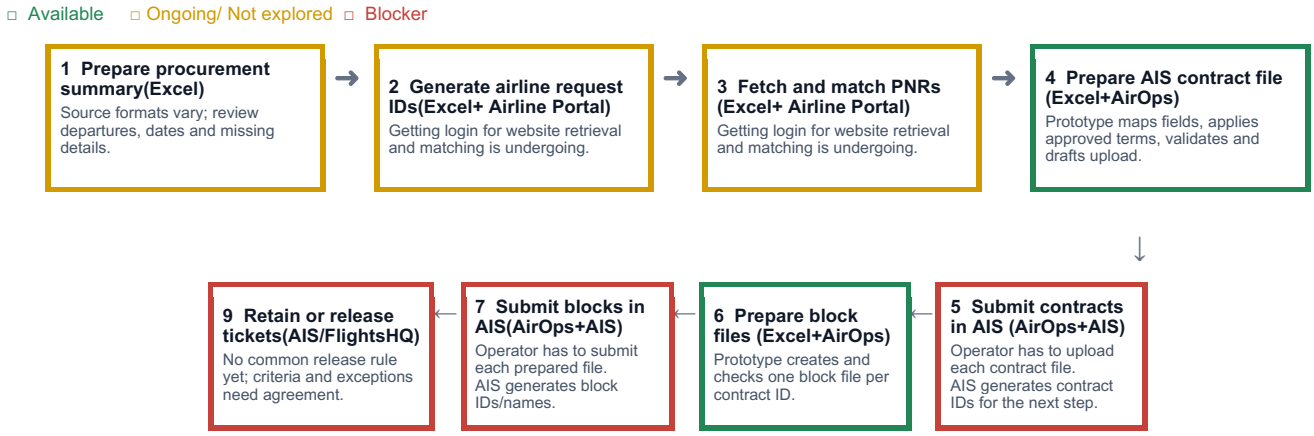
Air Ops Process Understanding

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Systems Involved

- AIS(Inventory Management)
- Excel(Manual Workload)
- AirOps(Proposed Tool)
- MOJO(Ticket Accounting DB)
- Flights HQ(Process Transparency)

Process at a glance



1. Prepare the procurement summary

A team member prepares a procurement summary to define the timeline for which tickets are to be procured. The details used to build it may arrive by vendor email or be downloaded from an airline website, and formats can vary. The summary gives the team a working view of the departures and dates that move into request creation and the AIS steps.

- Manual today: review the source information, identify the required sector and procurement timeline, and prepare the summary of departures and ticket details for that period.
- Potential automation: extract and group repeatable fields, map known airline formats, and flag missing or inconsistent information. A team member would still review unfamiliar formats or unclear details.

2. Generate airline request IDs

For an airline, sector, and period (for example, 1–31 December), an operator visits the airline platform, applies the search filters, selects a flight for each date, and submits the requests. The platform returns request IDs.

- Manual today: run the searches, select available flights, resolve platform errors, and open alternatives for dates with no suitable flight.
- Manual decision: choose the next-best option when results are unavailable or ambiguous.
- Potential automation: prepare date-wise searches and collect available options and outcomes; route ambiguous alternatives and uncertain submissions to an operator or next flight to the closest particular time.

3. Fetch PNRs for the requests

After request IDs are generated, the team returns to the airline website and retrieves the PNR for each respective request ID. The PNR is matched to the corresponding flight and date for the later AIS work.

- Manual today: look up request IDs, fetch PNRs, and record them against the correct procurement records.
- Potential automation: capture PNRs and reconcile them to request IDs in the excel summary sheet; show missing or mismatched PNRs as unresolved exceptions.

4. Prepare and submit contracts in AIS

AIS is the company's internal platform and database for contract and block creation. The procurement summary and approved airline terms are used to create contracts, either by manual entry or by uploading a batch in the AIS contract demo-template format. The team has described batch uploads of around 50 contracts. On submission, AIS generates contract IDs; the operator downloads the AIS result for the next stage.

- Manual today: map source values to AIS fields, choose contract options, apply airline terms, review and submit the file, then download and reconcile generated IDs.
- Automation Achieved: map procurement fields, group the correct flights into contracts, apply approved airline defaults, and identify gaps before the AIS upload.
- Known rules: reciprocal sectors are one return contract only when their legs share the same PNR; different PNRs remain separate one-way contracts. Contract start date is the creation date; end date is the last departure for that sector. Names use airline, sector, and month/year.

5. Prepare and submit block files in AIS

After contract IDs are available, block data is prepared from the procurement departures and the downloaded AIS contract result. The AIS block demo template defines upload columns. The intended output is one separate block file per contract ID. AIS generates block IDs and block names after the operator submits the prepared files.

- Manual today: connect contract IDs to departures, copy or derive flight, date, seat, and other values, fill remaining AIS fields, validate the template, and submit.
- Automation Achieved: generate a block file per contract, populate source-derived fields, use approved block-profile defaults only for values not present in the source, and validate routes, dates, PNRs, quantities, and headers.

6. Upload inventory and decide when to release tickets

After blocks are created, inventory is uploaded or made available for sale through the AIS/inventory workflow. The team then monitors inventory and decides whether tickets or seats should remain available or be released back to the airline. This release decision is fully manual today; the team has not identified one standard rule that fits every case.

- Manual today: review sales and remaining inventory, airline or supplier terms, applicable deadlines, and the operational situation; decide whether to retain or release inventory and complete the required action.
- Potential support: bring the relevant dates, remaining seats, sales position, and applicable terms into one review. Any recommendation depends on the team agreeing decision rules and exceptions first.

7. Flight HQ and MOJO

Flight HQ and MOJO support different parts of the MMT flight workflow. Flight HQ manages high-throughput APIs and pricing engines, with the aim of keeping pricing transparent. MOJO is used as an accounting ticket database and supports ticket updates, messages, and confirmations. In the Air Ops process, these tools sit alongside the airline websites and AIS and support operational work across the ticket lifecycle.

8. Manual work and automation opportunities

Stage	Manual work today	Potential automation scope
Request IDs and PNRs	Search airline site, resolve missing dates, submit, then retrieve and match PNRs.	Prepare repeated searches and capture results; send ambiguous choices to review.
Inventory release	Review stock and terms, decide whether to return tickets, and confirm action.	Provide decision context after the team defines release rules; keep approval manual until then.

9. AirOps solution built so far

The current AirOps preparation prototype reduces repeated spreadsheet work around AIS. It prepares files for an operator to review and upload. AIS still creates contract and block IDs, and an operator performs the AIS submissions.

- Contract preparation: reads supported procurement inputs, maps departure and route details, groups reciprocal legs by matching PNR, applies an approved airline T&C profile, validates fields, and prepares an AIS contract upload file.
- AIS handoff: the operator uploads the contract draft to AIS, downloads its result containing contract IDs, and returns that result to the block-preparation stage.
- Block preparation: combines the procurement source, AIS contract result, and selected Block Config/template to create a separate downloadable block file for each contract ID, with checks before download.
- Configuration and data: Airline T&C profiles and block profiles/templates are managed separately and persist. Case files stay in-session. The prototype does not log in to or submit data directly to AIS or airline websites.
- Not covered yet: airline website request-ID generation, PNR retrieval, inventory upload beyond preparing the block file, and the decision to release tickets back to airlines.